INTRODUCTION TO ATLAS.ti

Qualitative Data Analysis with ATLAS.ti

ATLAS.ti is one of the reliable software for the qualitative analysis; it helps the researcher to do its analysis based on codes, to identify which codes are used more or less. Below steps can help the researcher to better analysis with ATLAS.ti:

1.2. First Step

1.2.1. Starting ATLAS.ti

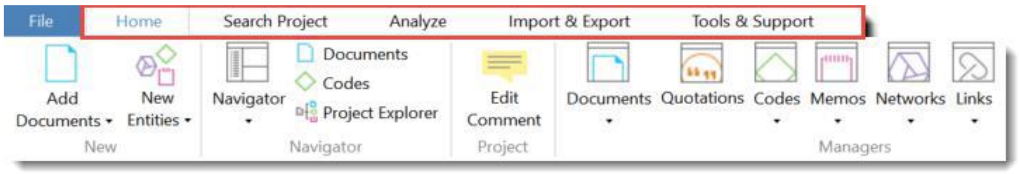
In Windows 10, start ATLAS.ti by typing "ATLAS.ti" into the Windows search field.

1.2.2. The ATLAS.ti Ribbon

There are five core tabs in ATLAS.ti Ribbon – Home, Search Project, Analyze, Import & Export, and Tools & Support.

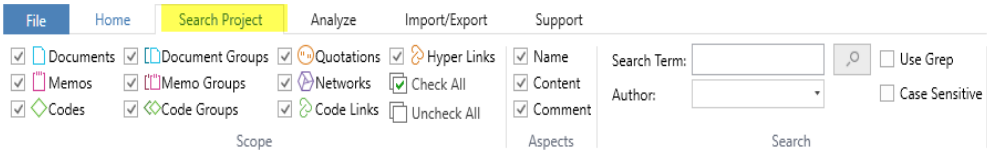
1.2.2.1. Home

The HOME tab is the starting point for most projects. You can start here to add documents to a project, create new codes, memos and networks (NEW ENTITIES), open various navigators to be displayed in the navigation area on the left-hand side of the screen, write a comment for your project, and open the various managers.



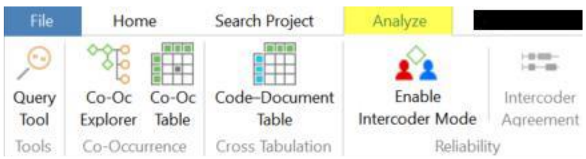
1.2.2.2. Search Project

The SEARCH PROJECT tab allows to search through all entities of your project.



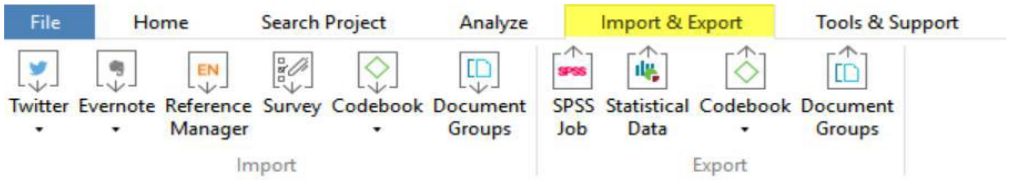
1.2.2.3. Analyze

The ANALYZE tab offers a number of advanced functions to analyze your data after coding.



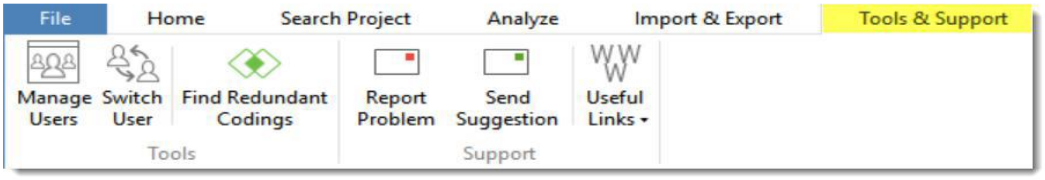
1.2.2.4. Import & Export

Use the IMPORT/EXPORT tab to import Twitter data, to add data stored in Evernote, to import data from reference managers like Endnotes, to import survey data, especially responses to open-ended questions, etc., to support the analysis of literature. Further, you can import and export code lists in Excel.



1.2.2.5. Tools & Support

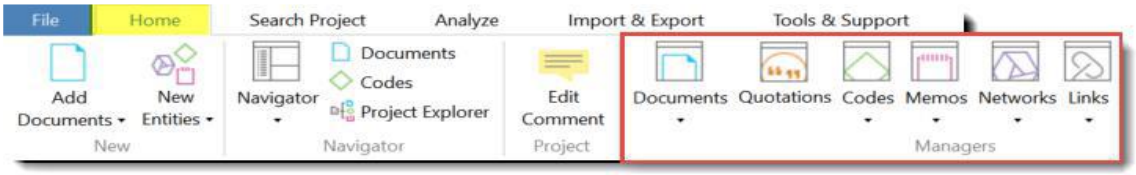
If you want to report a problem, send suggestions, create or manage user accounts, want to access the Quick Tour or other resources, click on the TOOLS &SUPPORT tab.



1.2.2.6. The Six Main Entity Types

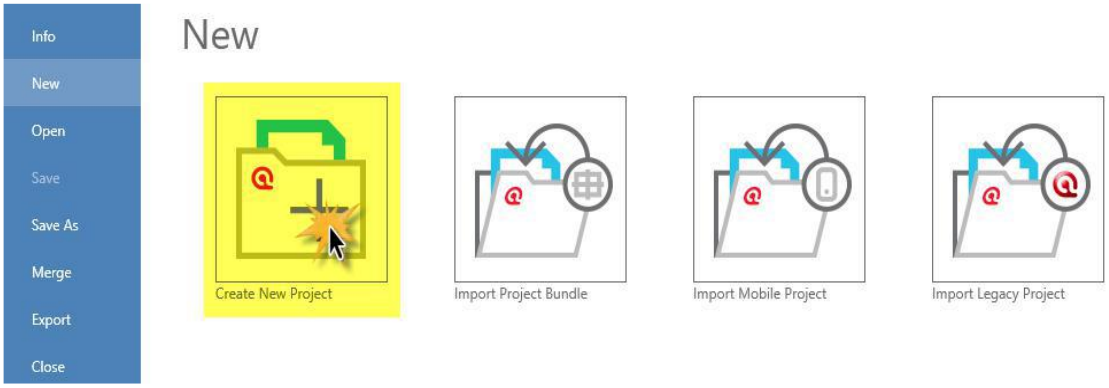
The six main entity types in ATLAS.ti are Documents, Quotations, Codes, Memos, Networks, and Links. All entity types have their own manager, which can be opened from the Home tab:

i) To open the Document Manager, click on the Documents button;
ii) to open the Quotation Manager, click on the Quotations button;
iii) to open the Code Manager, click on the Codes button, and so on.



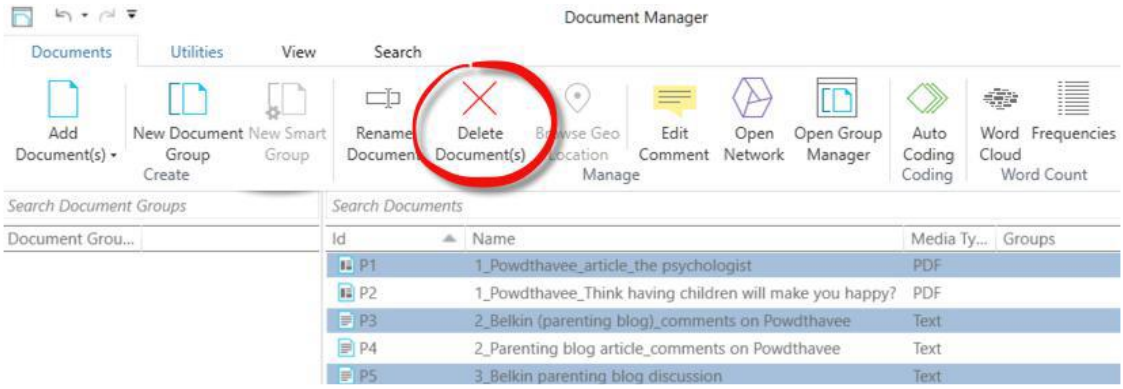
1.3. Second Step

Creating A New Project: To create a new project, click on FILE to open the backdrop menu. Select NEW. Click on the button: CREATE NEW PROJECT. Enter a project name like "My first project" and click on CREATE.



Adding Documents: To add documents, click on the ADD DOCUMENTS button in the HOME tab, or click on the dialog box launcher.

Removing / Deleting Documents from A Project: If you accidentally have added documents or want to remove them from your project for other reasons, you can select one or more documents in in the Project Explorer on the left-hand side, right-click and select the DELETE option from the context menu, or open the Document Manager, select one or more documents and select the DELETE DOCUMENT (S) button on the HOME tab. In the Document Manager, select the documents that you want to remove and click on the DELETE DOCUMENT(S) button. If you delete a document by mistake, you can always use the UNDO option in the Quick Access tool bar.



To renumber documents in consecutive order again, select the UTILITIES tab in the Document Manager and the RENUMBER DOCUMENTS option.



Saving Projects: To save a project, click on the Save icon in the Quick Access tool bar (see left), or select FILE / SAVE.

1.4. Third Step

1.4.1. Creating Word Clouds and Word Lists

To create a word cloud or list for just one document, right-click on a text document in the navigation panel and select the option WORD CLOUD / WORD LIST.



1.4.2. Creating Quotations

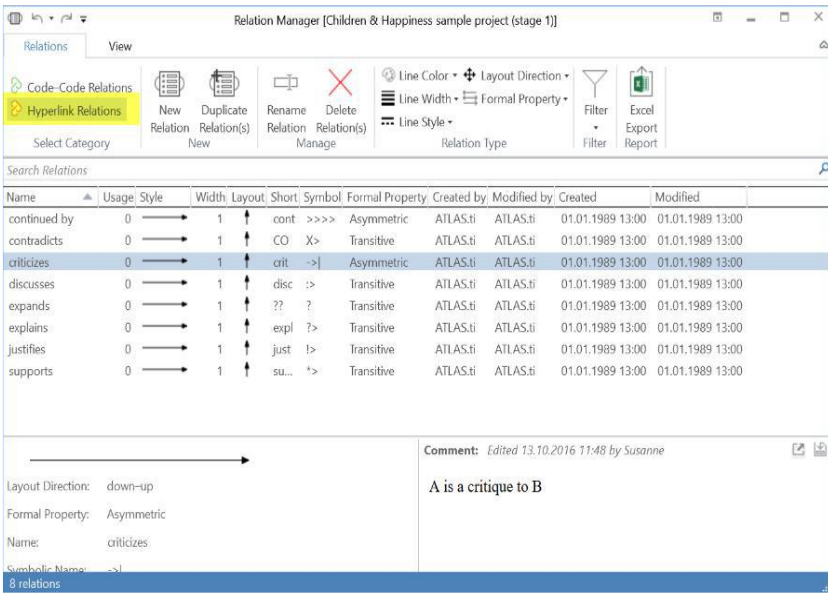
After highlighting something in the document, several buttons in the ribbon have become active. Select the first option" CREAT FREE QUOTATION.



Rename the quotation by right-clicking and selecting the option RENAME. Change the default name to "hook for article". You can read the quotation in full length in the preview field.

1.4.3. Creating Hyperlinks

A hyperlink is a named linked between two quotations. If, for instance, you notice that one statement in a report or interview is explaining a previous statement in a bit more detail, you can link the two using the relation "explains." Or you may find a contradictory or supporting statement.

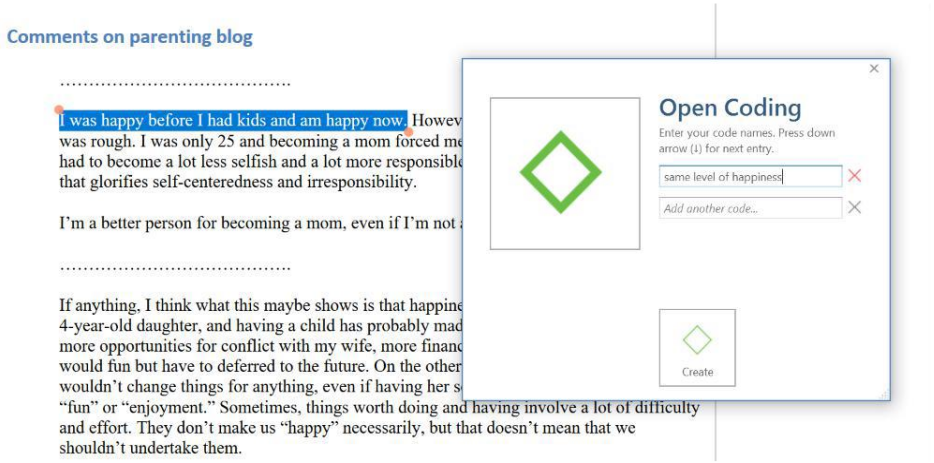


To create a hyperlink, you can simply drag and drop one quotation on top of another in the Quotation Manager

1.5. Fourth Step

1.5.1. Coding Data (Creating and Applying Codes)

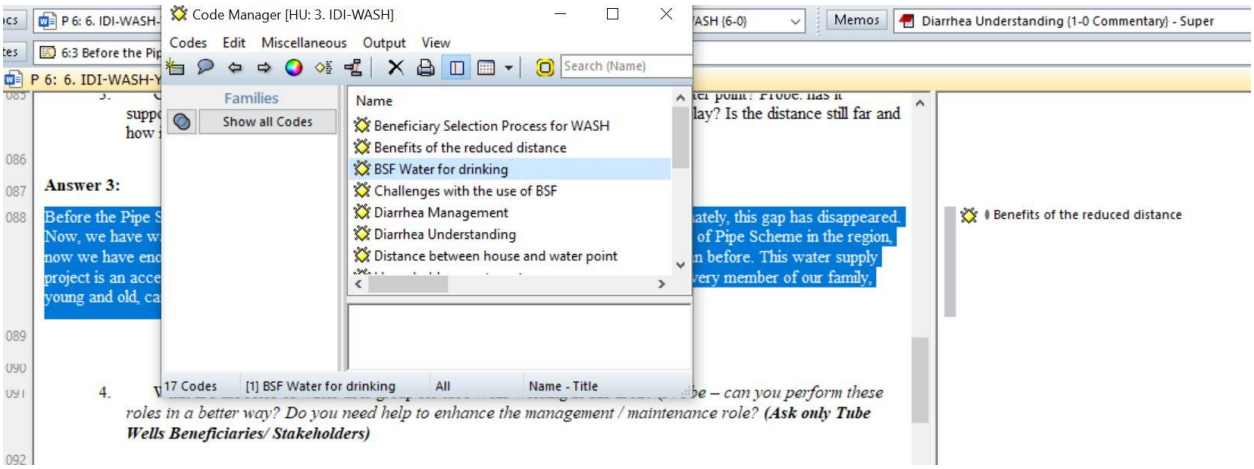
Use your mouse to highlight the first sentence beginning with any word. Next, click on the OPEN CODING button in the Document ribbon. As name enter the code and click CREATE. It is also possible to code a selection with multiple codes. You can enter as many codes as apply



1.5.2. Applying Existing Codes

Now, we would like to invite you to continue for a few minutes to code the document. If you come across a passage that you would like to code with an already existing code, you can link one of the existing codes either via drag & drop from the Project Explorer, or

you open the Code Manager as shown before. Dock the Code Manager into a new tab group to the right.

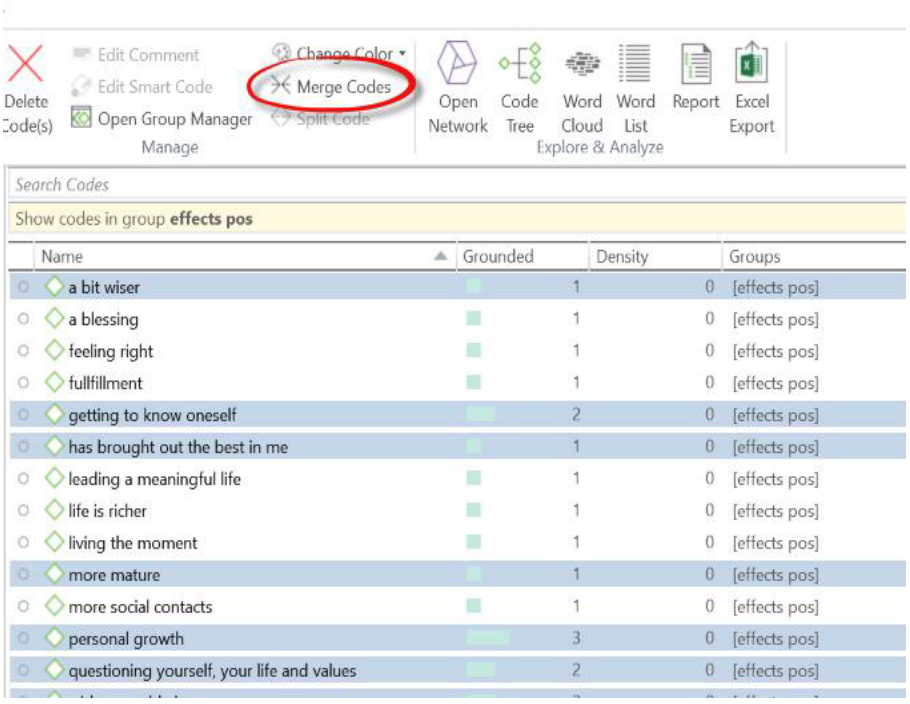


1.5.3. Replacing A Code

If you want to replace a code that is linked to a data segment, you can simply drag and drop another code from either the Navigator or the Code Manager on top of it.

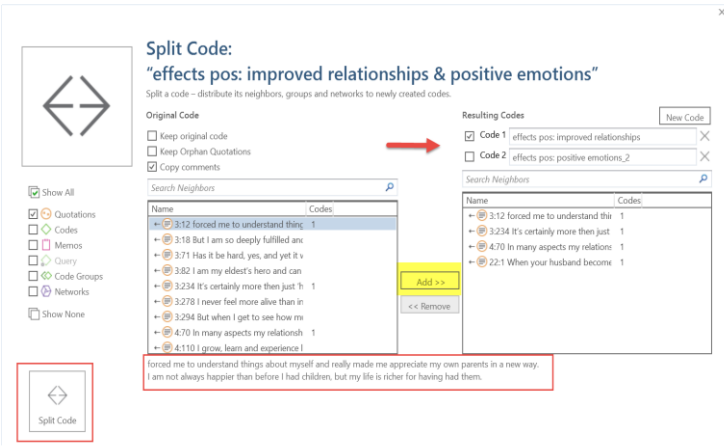
1.5.4. Merging Codes

You may begin your coding very close to the data generating lots of codes. In order not to drown in a long list of codes, you need to aggregate those codes from time to time, which means merging and renaming them to reflect the higher abstract level. Another reason for merging is that you realize that two codes have the same meaning but you have used two different labels.



1.5.5. Splitting A Code

Splitting a code is necessary if you have been lumping together many quotations under a broad theme. This is a suitable approach for a first run through to get an idea about your data. At some point, however, those codes need to be split up into smaller sub codes. Think of a basket full of fruits. At first it is OK to collect all kinds of fruits, but then the basket gets very full and you realize that it might be a good idea to use separate baskets for citrus fruits, apples and bananas.



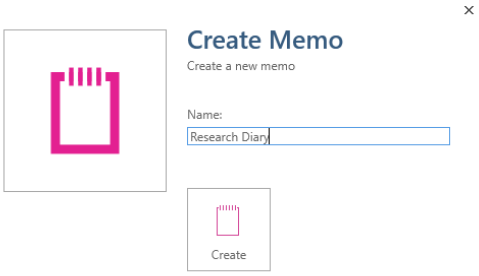
Select the code and click on the SPLIT CODE button in the Code Manager.

1.5.6. Creating Memos

Memos can be created from the HOME TAB, or in the Memo Manager.

To create a memo from the Home tab, open the drop-down menu of NEW ENTITIES and select FREE MEMO.

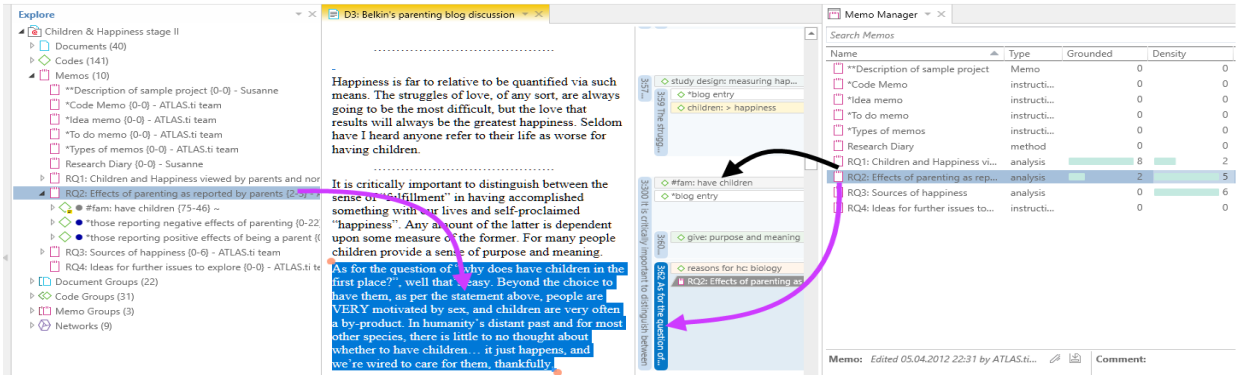
Enter a name for the new memo and click CREATE.



1.5.7. Linking Memos to Data Segments

Memos can be linked to quotations and codes. When writing such memos, you probably come across segments in your data (quotations) that nicely illustrate the points you are making in the memo. In order not to lose these quotations, you can link the memo to them. And this is how it works:

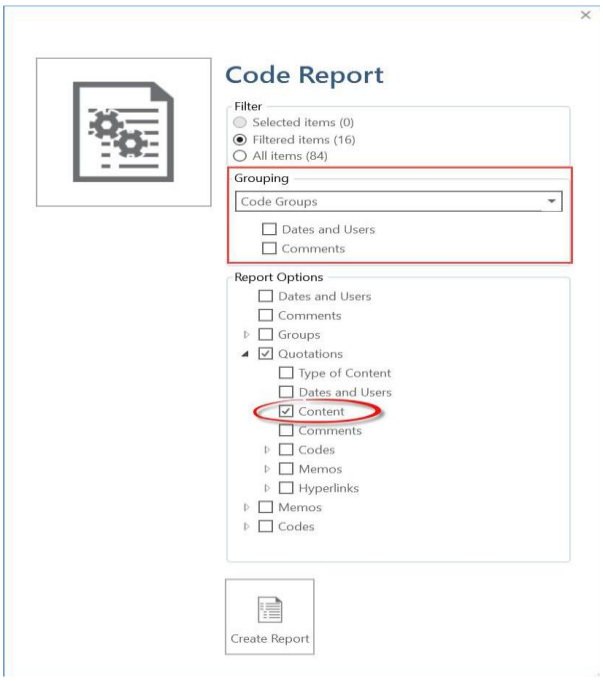
Drag and drop a memo from the Memo Manger or from the navigator.



1.6. Fifth Step

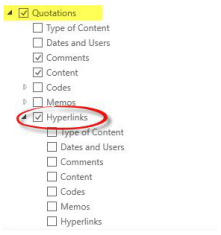
1.6.1. Creating Word / PDF Reports

Open the Code Manager and select one or more codes. Click on the REPORT button in the CODES tab.



The first option you may want to select is how the output is sorted. The default sort order is by code. If you select multiple codes from different code groups, you can choose to group the output by code groups. Or if you work in a team, you may want to view the quotations by creating or modifying user.

The next step is to select all items that you want to include in the report:





Click on the CREATE REPORT and then SAVE button on top of the report to save it either as Word or PDF file.